

**Birla Institute of Technology and Science
Pilani
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BITSMUN 2025

**INTERNATIONAL PRESS COMMITTEE
BACKGROUND GUIDE**

Letter from the Executive Board

Hello everyone, this is Kshitij, your lead for IP BITS MUN 25, I hope all of you are doing well. I am pursuing B.E. Civil Engineering from BITS Pilani. I have a strong interest in public speaking, mass communication and diplomacy.

It is with great enthusiasm that I welcome you to BITS MUN Pilani 2025, set to take place on the 29th and 30th of March at the prestigious Birla Institute of Technology and Science, Pilani. As the Executive Board, I am honored to host some of the most inquisitive and dynamic minds, and I eagerly anticipate the intellectual discourse and journalistic excellence you will bring to the conference.

Your role as journalists, photographers, and caricaturists is vital. Reporters will craft stories that capture the essence of debate, photographers will frame moments that define diplomacy, and caricaturists will provide a satirical yet insightful take on proceedings. Together, you will shape a powerful narrative that extends beyond committee walls.

At BITS MUN Pilani 2025, we aim to provide you with an enriching and immersive experience that fosters critical thinking, ethical journalism, and creativity. I encourage you to push boundaries, ask the right questions, and uphold the integrity of the press. Looking forward to seeing you all. Good Luck!

For any other queries, feel free to reach out.

Best regards,

Kshitij Maheshwari

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BITSMUN 2025 International Press Committee Background Guide: Mastering the Fourth Estate

This comprehensive guide equips press committee participants with essential knowledge, strategies, and creative approaches needed to produce outstanding coverage at BITSMUN 2025. By combining journalistic excellence with diplomatic understanding, you will serve as the critical link between committee proceedings and the broader audience.

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Introduction: The Power and Purpose of International Press

Understanding Your Role in Model UN Diplomacy

As a member of the International Press committee (IPC), you represent more than just media—you are the eyes, ears, and voice of BITSMUN. Unlike delegates who represent countries and negotiate solutions, your task is to document, analyze, and disseminate information about conference proceedings. This responsibility goes beyond simple reporting; you shape narratives, influence perspectives, and create a lasting record of diplomatic interactions.

The relationship between the United Nations and press mirrors the real world where media serves multiple crucial functions:

1. **Information Bridge:** You connect committee deliberations to audiences outside, making complex diplomatic negotiations accessible to the public.
2. **Accountability Agent:** Through your coverage, delegates remain accountable to their positions and commitments, knowing their statements and actions are documented.
3. **Narrative Weaver:** You highlight connections between seemingly disparate issues across committees, providing context that delegates focused on single issues might miss.
4. **Historical Archivist:** Your work creates a permanent record of the conference, capturing not just outcomes but the process of negotiation itself.

The BITSMUN Press Experience

BITSMUN's 13th edition in November 2025 brings together participants from across India and internationally, with previous editions seeing delegates from the USA, Canada, Singapore, Qatar, Kuwait, Sri Lanka, Pakistan, and Afghanistan. Your press coverage will need to be equally global in perspective while maintaining your publication's specific voice.

Working as press at BITSMUN offers distinct advantages:

- Freedom to observe all committees rather than being confined to one
- Opportunities to interact with diverse delegates across the conference
- Creative flexibility in coverage approaches and storytelling methods
- Unique awards specifically for press excellence

Press committee Structure and Operations

Media Roles and Responsibilities

The International Press committee comprises three core roles, each requiring distinct skills:

1. **Journalists/Reporters:** Responsible for written coverage including news reports, feature articles, editorials, and interviews. You must balance factual accuracy with your publication's perspective.
2. **Photographers:** Capture visual narratives of committee proceedings, delegate interactions, and notable moments. Effective press photography requires both technical skill and storytelling vision.
3. **Caricaturists/Illustrators:** Create visual commentary and artistic interpretations of conference dynamics, adding depth and personality to coverage.

Daily Workflow

A typical day in the press committee follows this pattern:

Morning Briefing (8:30-9:00 AM)

- Review of day's committee agendas
- Assignment of coverage priorities
- Discussion of overnight developments

Committee Coverage (9:00 AM-12:30 PM)

- Observation of proceedings
- Note-taking on key debates
- Interviewing delegates during breaks

Midday Editorial Meeting (12:30-1:30 PM)

- Pitch story ideas
- Share observations across committees

- Receive feedback from editorial team

Afternoon Coverage (1:30-5:00 PM)

- Continue committee observation
- Conduct scheduled interviews
- Begin drafting articles/editing photos

Evening Production (5:00-7:00 PM)

- Finalize content for publication
- Submit articles for editorial review
- Prepare for next day's coverage

Publication Standards and Expectations

Each press delegate is expected to produce:

- At least one substantial piece daily (article, photo essay, or illustration)
- Contributions to special features as assigned
- Coverage that maintains journalistic integrity while reflecting your publication's perspective

Your work must distinguish clearly between fact and opinion, label analysis appropriately, and adhere to ethical standards including proper attribution and consent for interviews. Remember that while you represent a news agency with its own biases, readers must still be able to extract facts from your reporting.

Research Methodology for Press committee

Pre-Conference Preparation

Effective press committee participation begins long before the conference itself:

1. **Understand Your Publication:** Research your assigned news agency's history, editorial stance, typical coverage areas, and writing style. Are you representing a conservative or liberal outlet? A state-controlled publication or independent media? These factors should influence your reporting approach.
2. **Study Committee Topics:** Thoroughly research all agenda items for the committees you'll cover, including historical context, key debates, and recent developments. While delegates focus on one committee, you need working knowledge of all four.
3. **Research Country Positions:** Familiarize yourself with the positions of major countries on each agenda item, particularly those representing powerful blocs or those central to the issues being discussed.
4. **Develop Background Knowledge:** Build contextual understanding of UN structures, rules of procedure, and previous resolutions related to committee topics.

Source Development and Management

Successful press committee members cultivate diverse information sources:

1. **Official Documentation:** Study background guides, position papers, and draft resolutions as primary sources.
2. **Delegate Interviews:** Develop relationships with key delegates for quotes and insights, but always identify yourself as press and obtain consent before publishing information.
3. **Committee Observation:** Systematically observe debate patterns, alliance formations, and power dynamics within committees.

4. Expert Consultation: When available, seek input from faculty advisors, organizing committee members, or subject matter experts.
5. Cross-Referencing: Verify information across multiple sources before including it in your reporting.

Note-Taking Best Practices

Effective journalists develop systematic note-taking methods:

- Record exact quotes with attribution for potential inclusion
- Document key arguments and counterarguments
- Note emotional reactions and body language when relevant
- Prioritize capturing substantive content over trying to record everything
- Focus on points of conflict or cooperation between delegations

Avoid the common pitfall of trying to document every statement. Instead, focus on capturing the most impactful quotes that directly support your narrative.



Committee-Specific Background and Coverage Strategies

Committee 1: Dharamkshetra - Reviewing Deeds and Destinies in Chitragupta's Court

Background and Context

This unique mythological simulation centers on Chitragupta, the divine accountant in Hindu mythology who maintains records of human actions. After death, souls face judgment based on their karma (actions), with Chitragupta presenting their life's ledger to Lord Yama, the God of Death.

Key elements to understand:

- Chitragupta's role in recording all human actions
- Concepts of karma, dharma, and moral judgment
- The cyclical nature of rebirth and ultimate liberation (moksha)
- The balance of good and bad deeds in determining one's fate

Research Directions

Thoroughly research these areas to inform your coverage:

1. Hindu Mythological Texts: Study the Garuda Purana and sections of the Mahabharata that detail Chitragupta's role and the judgment process.
2. Modern Ethical Frameworks: Research contemporary moral dilemmas that parallel committee debates, such as:
 - Environmental ethics versus economic development
 - AI ethics and automation of moral decisions
 - Corporate responsibility versus individual accountability
 - Free speech boundaries and harmful expression
3. Historical Judgment Cases: Identify controversial historical figures or decisions that might serve as case studies for the committee.

Creative Coverage Ideas

For Journalists:

- Create "Cosmic Court Proceedings" articles written as divine records
- Develop "Karmic Balance Sheets" analyzing moral arguments
- Write "Ethical Dilemma of the Day" features highlighting complex moral questions
- Conduct interviews with delegates posing as historical figures awaiting judgment

For Photographers:

- Capture delegates making "weighing" gestures symbolizing moral judgment
- Use dramatic lighting to create the atmosphere of a divine court
- Focus on facial expressions during particularly tense ethical debates
- Create symbolic images representing karma, dharma, and judgment

For Caricaturists:

- Draw delegates with divine attributes based on their moral positions
- Illustrate arguments as items being weighed on cosmic scales
- Depict powerful delegates as reincarnated historical figures
- Create humorous representations of karma's consequences

Committee 2: AIPPM - All India Political Parties Meet

Agenda A: Should India Re-evaluate Free Speech Laws?

Background and Context

India's approach to free speech has evolved significantly, with recent developments including:

- Striking down of the 2023 fact-checking amendments to IT Rules
- Ongoing debates about sedition laws and their application
- Tensions between Article 19 protections and reasonable restrictions
- Digital speech regulation challenges on social media platforms

Key international models for comparison include Germany's strict Network Enforcement Act versus America's First Amendment protections.

Research Directions

1. Recent Legal Cases: Study landmark judgments like the Shreya Singhal case and recent High Court decisions on free speech.
2. International Comparisons: Research speech regulation approaches in democracies worldwide, from Germany's restrictive model to America's more permissive approach.
3. Technology and Speech: Investigate how digital platforms have complicated traditional speech regulation.

4. Constitutional Framework: Analyze Article 19 and its reasonable restrictions under Article 19(2).

Creative Coverage Ideas

For Journalists:

- Create side-by-side comparisons of global free speech models
- Develop "Free Speech Index" ratings for different proposals
- Write hypothetical "Day in the Life" scenarios under proposed regulations
- Analyze how different media would operate under various regulatory frameworks

For Photographers:

- Capture symbols of speech and censorship during debates
- Focus on physical gestures that represent silencing or amplification
- Document expressions of passion during free speech discussions
- Create visual metaphors for different regulatory approaches

For Caricaturists:

- Draw speech bubbles of varying sizes representing different free speech models
- Illustrate the balance between freedom and responsibility
- Create visual metaphors for censorship and its consequences
- Depict the competing interests in speech regulation debates

Agenda B: India's Economic Future

Background and Context

India's economic policy debates center around several key issues:

- Privatization of state enterprises (e.g., Air India's transformation)
- Agricultural reform and farm laws
- Taxation structures and exemptions
- Balance between growth and equitable distribution

Research Directions

1. Privatization Cases: Study recent privatization efforts, their implementation challenges, and outcomes.
2. Agricultural Economics: Research agricultural income taxation debates and exemption policies.
3. Global Economic Models: Investigate different economic approaches worldwide and their applicability to India.
4. Demographic Impacts: Analyze how various economic policies affect different socioeconomic groups in India.

Creative Coverage Ideas

For Journalists:

- Create data visualizations comparing economic outcomes under different policies
- Develop "Economic Impact Profiles" for various demographic groups
- Write analysis pieces connecting historical economic reforms to current proposals
- Profile hypothetical citizens from different backgrounds under proposed policies

For Photographers:

- Capture contrasts between tradition and modernization in economic debates
- Document physical reactions during discussions of wealth distribution
- Focus on symbolic objects representing different economic philosophies
- Create visual stories of economic transformation and its human impact

For Caricaturists:

- Draw politicians balancing on economic tightropes
- Illustrate the pull between different economic forces
- Create visual metaphors for tax loopholes or regulatory gaps
- Depict the winners and losers under different economic approaches

Committee 3: UNHRC - Human Rights Impact of China's Belt and Road Initiative

Background and Context

China's Belt and Road Initiative (BRI) represents one of the most ambitious infrastructure development programs in history, spanning Asia, Africa, and parts of Europe. However, it raises significant human rights concerns:

- Debt trap diplomacy and sovereignty implications
- Labor rights violations and workforce issues
- Environmental degradation and community displacement
- Corporate accountability challenges
- Connection to China's domestic human rights situation

Research Directions

1. Case Studies: Research specific BRI projects in Pakistan (CPEC), Sri Lanka (Hambantota Port), Myanmar, and Central Asia.

2. Debt Dynamics: Analyze financial arrangements and their consequences for participating nations.
3. Environmental Impact: Study ecological consequences of major infrastructure projects.
4. Labor Practices: Investigate working conditions, local employment versus Chinese workers, and labor rights issues.
5. Geopolitical Context: Understand how BRI fits into broader international power dynamics.

Creative Coverage Ideas

For Journalists:

- Create "BRI Human Impact" series profiling affected communities
- Develop comprehensive maps showing BRI projects and associated concerns
- Write comparative analyses of Western-led versus Chinese development approaches
- Profile debt situations of specific countries participating in BRI

For Photographers:

- Create visual juxtapositions of infrastructure development and human consequences
- Document symbolic representations of China's international influence
- Focus on delegate interactions representing power imbalances
- Capture emotional moments during human rights testimonies

For Caricaturists:

- Draw countries caught in debt or dependency relationships
- Illustrate the spread of Chinese influence through infrastructure
- Create visual metaphors for sovereignty concerns
- Depict the contrast between BRI promises and realities

Committee 4: UNGA - Reforming the UN Security Council

Background and Context

The United Nations Security Council structure established in 1945 increasingly fails to reflect contemporary global realities. Key issues include:

- Permanent membership limited to five nations (P5) with veto power
- Underrepresentation of Africa, Latin America, and other regions
- Increasing calls for reform from G4 nations (Brazil, India, Japan, Germany)

- Opposition from "Coffee Club" or "Uniting for Consensus" group
- Tensions between representation, effectiveness, and power dynamics

Research Directions

1. Historical Reform Efforts: Study previous UNSC reform proposals and why they failed.
2. Power Dynamics: Analyze how current structure affects global power balances.
3. Regional Representation: Research arguments for geographical distribution changes.
4. Veto Reform Proposals: Study suggestions for modifying or limiting veto powers.
5. Membership Criteria: Investigate proposed standards for permanent membership.

Creative Coverage Ideas

For Journalists:

- Create "Security Council Reimagined" visualizations of different proposals
- Develop "Veto Watch" tracking of how veto power influences debates
- Write "Voices of the Excluded" profiles featuring nations seeking representation
- Analyze historical crises and how different UNSC structures might have responded

For Photographers:

- Capture images representing inclusion versus exclusion
- Document power dynamics through physical positioning of delegates
- Focus on symbolic gestures of authority or submission
- Create visual representations of structural inequality in global governance

For Caricaturists:

- Draw the UNSC as an exclusive club with difficult entry requirements
- Illustrate the disproportionate influence of veto-wielding nations
- Create visual metaphors for reform obstacles
- Depict the world trying to balance on an uneven security structure

Journalistic Skills and Best Practices

Article Types and Structures

1. News Reports

- Focus on factual reporting of committee proceedings
- Follow inverted pyramid structure (most important information first)
- Include relevant quotes from delegates
- Maintain objectivity while reflecting your publication's perspective
- Typically 400-600 words

2. Feature Articles

- Provide in-depth analysis of specific issues or trends
- Incorporate multiple perspectives and sources
- Use narrative techniques to engage readers
- Can include more descriptive language
- Typically 800-1200 words

3. Editorials/Opinion Pieces

- Present clear viewpoints consistent with your publication's stance
- Support arguments with evidence from committee proceedings
- Label clearly as opinion/analysis
- Address counterarguments
- Typically 600-800 words

4. Interviews

- Prepare questions in advance based on thorough research
- Clearly identify yourself as press when requesting interviews
- Obtain consent regarding attribution
- Capture direct quotes accurately
- Present in Q&A or narrative format

Mastering Interview Techniques

Effective interviewing is central to quality press coverage:

1. Preparation: Research the delegate and their country's positions before approaching them.
2. Introduction: Always identify yourself and your publication when requesting an interview.
3. Consent: Clearly establish how you'll attribute information—by name, position, or as background information.
4. Question Structure: Begin with open-ended questions, then narrow to specific points.
5. Active Listening: Pay attention to responses and ask follow-up questions rather than rigidly following a script.
6. Note-Taking: Focus on capturing key quotes accurately rather than transcribing everything.
7. Timing: Respect delegates' time constraints; most interviews should take 5-10 minutes.
8. Balanced Perspective: Seek diverse viewpoints across blocs and positions.

Press Conference Strategies

Press conferences provide structured opportunities to question delegates publicly:

1. Research Thoroughly: Prepare questions based on committee proceedings and country positions.
2. Question Development: Craft questions that are concise, specific, and designed to elicit substantive responses.
3. Strategic Positioning: Consider how your questions might influence committee dynamics or reveal important information.
4. Follow-Up Preparation: Be ready with follow-up questions based on potential responses.
5. Focus on Significance: Target delegates in pivotal positions or those representing important perspectives on key issues.
6. Coordination: Sometimes coordinate with other press members to ensure comprehensive coverage of all angles.

Photography and Visual Documentation

Effective visual coverage requires both technical skill and journalistic judgment:

1. **Story-Focused Shooting:** Capture images that tell stories rather than merely documenting presence.
2. **Moment Sensitivity:** Anticipate and capture significant interactions, reactions, and expressions.
3. **Context Creation:** Include visual elements that establish setting and circumstances.
4. **Ethical Considerations:** Respect delegates' privacy and dignity while documenting proceedings.
5. **Technical Quality:** Ensure proper lighting, composition, and clarity in all images.
6. **Captioning:** Provide accurate, descriptive captions identifying subjects and context.



Competitive Edge Strategies

Award-Winning Coverage Approaches

To stand out in the press competition, consider these proven strategies:

1. **Thematic Series:** Develop a consistent thematic approach across your coverage—for example, "Power Dynamics" or "Voices of the Marginalized".
2. **Distinctive Voice:** Establish a recognizable writing style or visual aesthetic that sets your work apart.
3. **Cross-Committee Analysis:** Make connections between different committees that other press members might miss.
4. **Exclusive Angles:** Find unique perspectives or stories others overlook—perhaps focusing on underrepresented countries or emerging coalitions.
5. **Multimedia Integration:** Combine writing, photography, and graphics in compelling packages.
6. **Investigative Approach:** Dig deeper than surface-level reporting to uncover the strategies and motivations behind delegate actions.

Creating Signature Features

Develop recurring content formats that become associated with your coverage:

1. **Daily Briefings:** Concise summaries of key developments across all committees.
2. **Delegate Profiles:** In-depth looks at notable delegates and their approaches.
3. **Resolution Breakdowns:** Analysis of draft resolutions and their implications.
4. **Behind-the-Scenes:** Coverage of informal negotiations and alliance-building.
5. **Prediction Pieces:** Forecasts of voting outcomes or strategic shifts.
6. **Symbolic Moments:** Identification and analysis of pivotal turning points in committees.

Building Professional Relationships

Successful press committee members cultivate relationships that enhance their coverage:

1. **Source Development:** Build trust with key delegates who can provide insights.
2. **Editorial Collaboration:** Work effectively with other press committee members.
3. **Feedback Solicitation:** Actively seek input on your work to continually improve.
4. **Conflict Navigation:** Handle disagreements professionally, recognizing that your role sometimes involves reporting uncomfortable truths.
5. **Committee Chair Connection:** Establish professional relationships with chairs for context and background information.

Conclusion: Ethical Reporting in Model UN

Your role in the International Press committee carries significant responsibilities. While competitive success matters, remember that your primary mission is to inform, analyze, and document the diplomatic process accurately. Your work creates the historical record of BITSMUN 2025 and shapes how participants understand their experience.

Excellent press coverage requires balancing several competing priorities:

- Factual accuracy with engaging storytelling
- Your publication's perspective with fair representation
- Creative approaches with journalistic standards
- Competition for awards with ethical reporting principles

As you prepare for BITSMUN 2025, remember that the most respected journalists are those who maintain their integrity while producing compelling content that illuminates the complex world of international diplomacy. Your press credentials give you unique access and perspective—use these privileges responsibly to create coverage that informs, engages, and elevates the conference experience for all participants.

We look forward to seeing your outstanding coverage at BITSMUN 2025!